

it runs popular websites such as GitHub and Hulu.

Rails is a framework for creating websites that is built on Ruby, that embraces and encourages many software engineering best practises. It greatly simplifies building a RESTful website by automating a large



The diaspora* social network introduced features like contact groups (circles) that are now available in both Google+ and Facebook.

part of the process using auto-code-generation tools and a philosophy of “convention over configuration”.

Ruby is also the language of choice of the open-source social network software diaspora*. While the project never reached critical mass — or it hasn't yet — the choice of technology for such a project is critical. The diaspora* is not only open-source, but also decentralised, allowing people hosting their profile on different servers to be friends.

Another major consumer of Ruby is YaST (Yet another Setup Tool), a collection of tools for Linux administrators to configure different parts of the system. It is software developed by the OpenSUSE community for their distro. YaST was originally written in a custom programming language called YCP, which had the obvious disadvantage that only developers of YaST knew it or cared about it. For their 13.1 release in 2013 that developers decided to switch to Ruby due to its popularity with developers and the chance to inject fresh blood to this important project.

Ruby, while fluctuating up and down on the TIOBE rankings, still happens to stay in the top 20 languages. It ranks highly (4th) among the languages on GitHub though, with over a hundred thousand active repositories.

Perhaps the most popular and significant thing to come with Ruby though is Rails. Its flexibility and ease of use, along with easy deployment to hosts such as Heroku, has given it a huge boost and put it in great demand.

It's a simple language to learn, yet quite powerful. It has also has the advantage of a large community, and thousands of great libraries and packages.